OXENTIA

Oxford's Global
Innovation Consultancy

Oxentia proposal for Khalifa University Enterprise Company

Development and implementation of a Knowledge Exchange and Commercialisation strategy

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1. Executive summary

1.1 Our understanding of your objectives

Khalifa University Enterprise Company (KUEC) has been tasked with developing a leading international innovation ecosystem at Khalifa University (KU), Abu Dhabi. Oxentia, a leading innovation management consultancy, experienced in developing innovation ecosystems all over the world, have been asked to help achieve this goal. Specifically, Oxentia have been asked to support the development of six key components of the KU innovation ecosystem, which includes:

- Supporting the development and implementation of the KUEC strategic plan.
- Reviewing and developing the systems and processes used by the Technology Management and Innovation (TMI) office to support commercialisation of KU academic outputs. This includes a full review of the KU patent portfolio.
- Reviewing and developing the systems and processes used by the Khalifa incubation Center, and assessing their effectiveness.
- Supporting the creation of a Techno Park at KU. This includes benchmarking selected innovation ecosystems, developing a vision for KU through to supporting contract and tenancy agreements.
- Developing a Venture Investing facility to support companies incubated at KU, and to build a pipeline of co-investment opportunities from strategic partner organisations into KU.
- Defining KU's consultancy and laboratory services offering, including mapping the available services, and costing and pricing services.

Throughout the project, Oxentia will collaborate closely with the KUEC team, engage stakeholders, and ensure alignment with the university's strategic goals. The project plan will incorporate regular quarterly in-person meetings and progress reporting to track achievements and make necessary adjustments.

By implementing this project proposal, Oxentia aims to support the establishment of a vibrant innovation ecosystem, attract talent and investment opportunities, and drive the growth and success of Khalifa University Enterprise Company.

We are excited about the opportunity to work with the KUEC team and contribute to the development of a thriving innovation ecosystem in Abu Dhabi. Our expertise, collaborative approach, and commitment to excellence will ensure the successful implementation of this project.

1.2 Key features of this proposal

We provide here a proposal that describes how Oxentia will work with Khalifa University Enterprise Company. Key features of this proposal include:

- Quarterly onsite meetings – to ensure timely development of deliverables, stakeholder alignment and opportunities to engage key actors and progress individual projects.
- A workplan consisting of six workstreams, aligned with the KUEC strategic development plan. The deliverables described in Section 3: Technical proposal, all map to specific activities in the KUEC strategic plan.
- A 28-month timeline for implementing the programme. Section 3.8: Timeline, commencing in September 2024 and concluding in December 2025

- The programmes pricing and invoicing schedule. Section 6: Commercial proposal.

In addition, we have included relevant case studies that provide examples where we have delivered similar projects, and biographies of expected team members.

Although we have described our proposed activities and deliverables in detail, we employ the agile methodology in our project delivery. This means we are flexible and open to iterative development of the workplan, to ensure that ultimately the deliverables meet stakeholder expectations.

At this stage the proposal is in a draft format. We welcome your feedback and the opportunity to further develop and customise the proposal to your needs.

2. About Oxentia

Oxentia Ltd is a successful innovation management and technology commercialisation consultancy that started in 2004 as an operating division within Oxford University Innovation Ltd, the world leading technology transfer company of the University of Oxford.

Oxentia's mission is to provide high quality innovation management consulting services and advice, derived directly from practitioners' perspectives to organisations around the world, adding value and enabling economic growth at all levels. Since inception, Oxentia has engaged with large corporate businesses and SMEs, university spinouts, research organisations foundations, and governments as well as academics from research institutions and universities across most continents of the world.

We have managed a diverse range of cultural approaches within different socio-economic environments, which has given us a unique perspective on innovation and commercialisation strategies that can be implemented in different regions and countries. Our team has an exceptional blend of technical and commercial experience that cuts across most research disciplines, including in the agricultural technology, environmental, life science, digital, electronics, materials, engineering and medical device sectors, which makes us uniquely suited to engage with international tech-based innovators. To date, Oxentia has worked with clients in more than 70 countries.

3. Technical proposal

3.1 Our approach

Following conversations with Khalifa University, we have structured our proposal so that it is aligned with the KUEC implementation roadmap. We have discussed which activities Oxentia can support in the roadmap, and these are identified in the following sections (3.2 – 3.7). Each section begins with a brief 'description of workstream' which describes the main purpose of the workstream, and then under 'workstream deliverables' there is description of what work will be done for the respective deliverables.

The title of each deliverable is indicated by its suffix, for example in section 3.3.4 IP Portfolio Review **(D2.4)** the D = deliverable, 2 = Workstream 2, and 4 = the 4th deliverable in the respective workstream. There are between two and five deliverables for each workstream.

Where individual line items in the roadmap have been grouped together into a common deliverable, the individual line item is shown in bold text in the description of the deliverable. In some instances, the wording of the deliverable title is the same as the roadmap line item.

Section 3.8 provides a project timeline showing when the work for each activity will occur, this includes when the deliverable will be completed.

3.2 Workstream 1: Overall project

Description of workstream:

Workstream 1 brings together the overall project. This includes all activities that encompass the workstreams and their respective deliverables. Oxentia will support the following activities described in the sections below.

Workstream Deliverables:

3.2.1.Detailed Project Plan (D1.1)

Oxentia will work with KUEC CEO and colleagues, to produce a **detailed project plan** that describes how KUEC will be developed to create Abu Dhabi's leading innovation ecosystem. The project plan will describe how the key issues (Governance Framework, Investment Strategy, Seed Funding Process & Criteria, IP Licensing Process & Criteria) will be developed.

3.2.2.KUEC Strategy (D1.2)

We will work with the KUEC team to develop their **overall strategy,** from a strategic perspective, this will include defining the **target organisations** that will be part of the ecosystem. We will work closely with the KUEC team, involving key personal in discussions and workshops.

3.2.3.KUEC operating model (D1.3)

To deliver the KUEC strategy, and working with the KUEC team, Oxentia will develop an **overall operating model for KUEC.** This will involve identifying the key components required in KUs innovation ecosystem (e.g. incubators, accelerators, mentoring programs, and funding mechanisms.). Defining how these elements align with the University's mission, and establishing the organisation structure and communication channels, between the different internal components and external structures. From an operational perspective, this will include **defining the KU – KUEC**

shared service agreement, and from a strategic perspective this will require developing an **overall business plan for the KUEC**, in part by consolidating the business plans of other units.

3.2.4. Project Management (D1.4)

To ensure smooth and efficient delivery of this entire project, we have included an additional deliverable in workstream 1, to capture project management activities. This includes face to face meetings to ensure the project is on track. Onsite agendas will be tailored for each meeting, but will typically include the following items:

Project Delivery

- Review the progress of ongoing work
- Meetings with relevant stakeholders to progress ongoing work
- Deliver the outputs of completed work
- Delivery of training and to facilitate TTO setup

Project Management

- Review project progress
- Agree resource and timelines of future work
- Review project risks, and if necessary discuss and agree actions to overcome issues
- Review and submit invoices

Our expectation is that a team of two Oxentia consultants will spend one week in Abu Dhabi every quarter.

3.3 Workstream 2: TMI and Licensing

Description of workstream:

This workstream involves all activities currently managed by the Technology Management and Innovation (TMI) office at Khalifa University Enterprise Company. Specifically:

Workstream Deliverables:

3.3.1. Review performance of TMI (D2.1):

Oxentia will provide a regular (quarterly) **review performance of the TMI office.** Initial work will involve agreeing and setting KPIs for the TMI. Examples of KPIs that may be set, include: number of new disclosures; number of market assessments; number of decisions made to progress or not existing projects; numbers of license deals; numbers of projects entering new venture pipeline; amount of proof of concept funding deployed; and numbers of collaborative projects.

The KPIs will be agreed in the first quarter, and thereafter will be measured in subsequent quarters, producing a dashboard of TMI activity that will be used to report to the KUEC board on TMI activity, during our quarterly in-person meetings.

3.3.2. IP policy and revenue sharing review (D2.2)

Oxentia will conduct a review of the KU IP policy which includes how licensing revenues are shared. This review will distinguish between **internally funded research** and **third party funded research**.

The review will include (where necessary) recommendations to update IP policy clauses, bringing them in line with current best practice to incentivise academic engagement in commercialisation activity. Following a review of the existing policy we will prepare a document that outlines our recommendations. A workshop (provisionally scheduled for March 2024) with key stakeholders; senior university administrators, faculty heads, selected academics and the KUEC team, will be held to review, develop and agree on the policy recommendations. The purpose of the workshop is to get buy-in and a sense of ownership from the stakeholders, and to modify recommendations to reflect the KU reality.

We will use the existing KU IP policy as the starting point. We will work with KU's legal team to produce a completed IP policy that can be either shared on the KU intranet or made publicly available. For the avoidance of doubt, Oxentia will not be providing legal advice or the specific wording of individual clauses, but we will work with the KU legal team to complete the (re)wording of the IP policy.

3.3.3.TMI strategy and operations (D2.3):

Oxentia will review and adjust as necessary the **TMI strategy** and operations. This will include a review of all governance and operating procedures; such as:

- *Defining the objectives and scope of the TTO* – determining the purpose of the TTOs activities and ensuring they align with the university's strategic goals, mission, and values.
- *Establishing the governance structure* – including an internal university management board, composed of selected university leadership that collectively represent all research groups and university management functions; and, a TTO advisory board, consisting of internal and external commercialisation experts. This will lead to recommendations on how to **adjust the TMI organisational structure.**
- *Development of policies and procedures* – documentation that provides guidance to TTO staff on how to conduct themselves, with respect to: confidentiality, conflict of interest, flexible work from home policy, use of university equipment and internet, and other rights and responsibilities.
- *Define the procedure to* ***assess and manage IP opportunities*** – describing how to conduct specific technology transfer activities, including: taking an invention disclosure, conducting market assessment, IP due diligence workflow, decision making criteria for patent filling; guidance documentation and term sheet for license negotiation, and spinout creation workflow. These changes will also include a new **commercialisation path assessment**.
- New enterprise policy and framework – documentation that captures all aspects of how new spinouts and startups are supported, including; the university's investment strategy to support new venture creation, for both the management of university funds (e.g. patent budgets; proof-of-concept, acceleration and seed funds) and external investor partnerships; and a staged gated workflow for the TTO to deliver new ventures (pre-incorporation requirements, development of the proposition, raising investment, preparing for incorporation, completion and post-completion support).

Work on this deliverable will commence with the March 2024 in-person quarterly meeting. The Oxentia team will spend one day of that week in the TMI office, meeting the team, understanding their current position and their ambitions regarding their own development.

The deliverable will be completed and presented in the September 2024 quarterly meeting.

3.3.4.IP Portfolio Review (D2.4):

Oxentia will deliver a **patent portfolio review**, that will follow a three-stage process covering project development plans, IP check and a market check (orange box in Figure 1). Following each stage patents that do not meet a minimum agreed standard will not pass on to the next level of assessment.

Figure 1: Oxentia patent portfolio review methodology

Development plans

The first stage of the patent portfolio review is to determine the ongoing and planned efforts to develop the technology. Given the large number of patents in the portfolio, the most efficient means of conducting this review is by surveying all lead academics with a patent. The survey will capture recent project progress (additional technical developments not included in the patents) and planned activities to bring the technology to market. It is essential that academics support and continue to develop their technologies, for successful commercialisation.

In most cases a recommendation to abandon the patent will be made where research groups are no-longer supporting a project.

IP check

Oxentia will review patent documents, published and unpublished, that constitute the Khalifa University patent portfolio, for all projects that have passed stage 1. These documents will be reviewed and a summary table produced capturing key patent data e.g. jurisdiction, priority date, validity, inventors, owners, co-owners, and other select patent data metrics. Oxentia will also review accompanying documentation, e.g. technology profiles, industry feedback, licenses, etc., that evidence efforts and progress towards commercialisation.

The patent status can provide important direction regarding commercialisation decisions. For example, a recommendation to abandon a patent will typically be made where patents are expiring or have a limited number of years remaining. The geographic coverage of patents will in part inform commercialisation options.

Market check

Projects that successfully make it through the previous two stages, will be analysed from a market needs perspective. This will be a desk-based exercise using proprietary tools, such as; Resolute AI, Markets and Markets, and other sources, to identify evidence of market need.

Findings from the market assessment, combined with those from the IP check and research development plans, will enable us to identify the high priority projects that should be supported immediately, and those that require further development.

It is also possible that a recommendation to abandon patents will be made at this stage. This may occur if evidence of market need is very weak and/or evidence of superior competitor solutions are identified.

As this deliverable (D2.4), and the previous deliverable (D2.3), both require engaging the TMI team, we propose using the same timelines. An initial kick-off meeting in March 2024 with the deliverable presented in September 2024.

3.4 Workstream 3: Incubation Services (KIC)

Description of workstream:

This workstream describes the support Oxentia will provide in reviewing and developing the incubation services provided by KUEC for KU spinout companies and collaborative new ventures. It is expected that these incubation services will be provided by the Khalifa Innovation Center (KIC), a division of KUEC.

Workstream Deliverables:

3.4.1.KIC strategic review (D3.1)

Oxentia will provide a **review of the KIC strategy**. The goal of the review is to assess the incubator's current performance, identify areas for improvement, and develop a strategic plan to maximize its effectiveness. The review will involve a comprehensive analysis of the incubator's operations, including its mission, vision, and objectives, as well as the services and resources it provides to startup ventures. The evaluation will consider the risks and expected outcomes of pursuing a strategy the prioritises international partnerships. The review will reflect on the incubator's track record in terms of startup success rates, funding outcomes, and overall impact on the entrepreneurial ecosystem.

One of the expected outcomes of the KIC strategic review will be recommendations on **adjusting target organisations of the incubator**. Other recommendations may also include recommendations on KIC service providers.

3.4.2.KIC Portfolio performance review (D3.2)

Oxentia will provide a **review of the KIC performance**. This review will be based on achievements against specific KPIs. In the event KPIs have not been set for the KIC, then Oxentia will agree KPIs with the KIC team that are align with the strategic objectives, as set out in the previous deliverable (D3.1). For example, KPIs may include:

- Number of companies incubated
- Startup success rate
- Investment raised by incubated companies
- Job creation
- Sales and revenues
- International companies incubated
- Partnerships with other universities

The KIC portfolio review will include a **startup portfolio review**, which will include segmenting the KIC KPI data by sector and industry to identify the strengths and weaknesses in the incubator. The types of observations that will be made will include: does the KIC incubator have a particular sector focus (or weakness). This analysis will feedback into the recommendations made in the KIC strategic review.

3.5 Workstream 4: Techno Park

Description of workstream:

The fourth workstream describes the support Oxentia will provide in the scoping out and developing a techno park at Khalifa University. This will include the early-stage vision and strategic work, and the more detailed business plan, contracts and policies.

Workstream Deliverables:

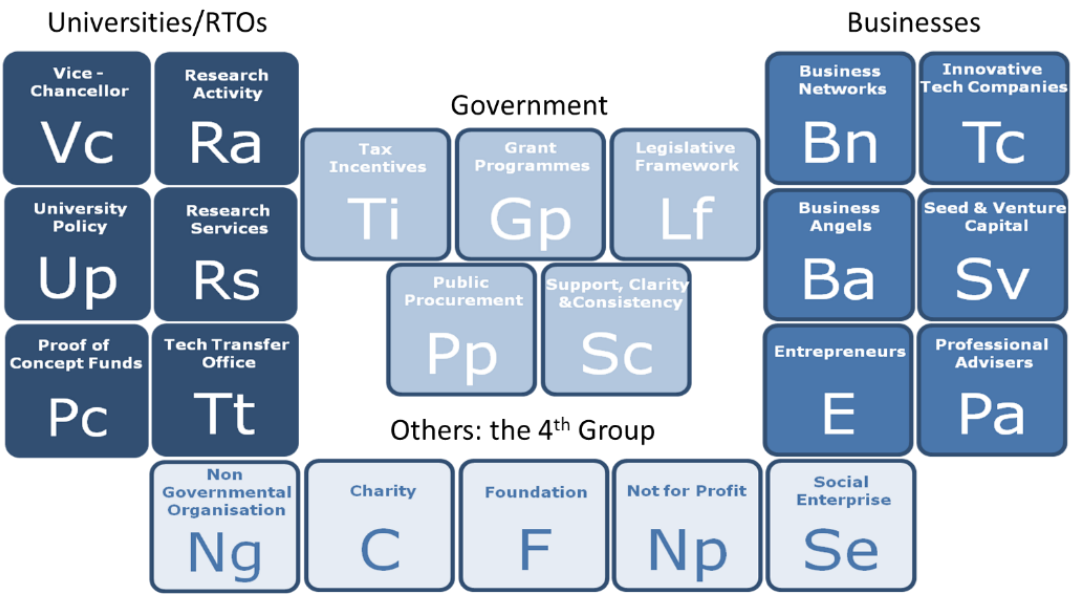
3.5.1. Innovation ecosystem benchmarking study (D4.1)

Oxentia will produce an innovation ecosystem benchmarking study on five regional ecosystems. One of these regions will be Abu Dhabi, another will be Oxford, and the other three are to be agreed.

The benchmarking study will describe the nature and features of the ecosystems as they are today, and it will also include the historical context and how each ecosystem evolved to its current position. The study will be used to help inform recommendations on actions needed to develop the innovation ecosystem in Abu Dhabi. Our recommendations will be tailored to the Abu Dhabi ecosystem, which means we will not advise '*...do X because that's what they do in Oxford or Silicon Valley...*' rather, our recommendations will be based on where the ecosystem is today and what are the appropriate actions that need to be taken, given the local context, to reach a particular vision.

To produce customised recommendations Oxentia will conduct a detailed analysis of the current Abu Dhabi ecosystem, using our own innovation ecosystem elements framework (Figure 2) that breaks down an ecosystem into its component parts.

Figure 2: Oxentia's elements of an innovation ecosystem framework



Analysing the Abu Dhabi ecosystem will involve many interviews, ideally with individuals that represent each of the elements will contribute to the data collection stage.

The outputs of the benchmarking study will inform the recommendations for many of the workstreams in this project, and will be of particular relevance to the development of the Techno Park.

3.5.2.Techno Park: vision, business plan, and objective setting (D4.2)

Oxentia will support the establishment of a Techno Park in Khalifa University. The park will be a dedicated innovation hub that fosters technological advancements, entrepreneurship, and collaboration among industry, academia, and the startup ecosystem. We will set out a **vision** and draft the **business plan** and agree the **objectives** of the KU Techno Park, with the aim of creating a catalyst for economic growth, job creation, and knowledge exchange in Abu Dhabi. The types elements captured in the business plan include:

- Infrastructure: research and development laboratories, co-working spaces, incubation centers, and shared resources and state-of-the-art facilities.
- Incubation and Acceleration Programs: customised programmes that provide mentoring, training, access to funding, and business development support for startups and SMEs – likely to be delivered through the KIC.
- Industry-Academia Collaboration: Facilitate knowledge transfer, collaborative research projects, and technology commercialization by forging strong partnerships between universities, research institutions, and industry players – particularly from high calibre international Universities.
- Networking and Events: Organize events, workshops, conferences, and networking sessions to foster knowledge exchange, connect entrepreneurs with investors, and showcase technological advancements.
- Funding and Investment: Establish funding mechanisms, such as seed capital funds, venture capital networks, and angel investor networks, to support startups and innovative projects – described in more detail in workstream 5.
- Policy and Regulatory Support: where possible work with government entities to create an enabling environment, proposing policies and incentives for technology-based businesses.

A key part of the Techno Park business plan will be **defining the target organisations** that we want to attract and be part of the Park. Engaging these organisations and communicating the KUEC offer. This objective cuts across the areas described above, and will include representatives from all the above groups (service providers, partners, clients etc.)

3.5.3.Techno Park tenant agreements (D4.3)

Oxentia will support negotiations with high profile tenants over the contractual agreements with tenants – pricing policy of agreements and the type and level of support provided by the Park. This will include **validating template lease agreement**, and the **creation of key procedure agreements**, for example the Techno Park managing agreement, and the office leasing procedure.

It should be noted that Oxentia does not provide legal services, and that the drafting of contracts and legal agreements will not be provided by Oxentia, but we will work with KUEC lawyers to facilitate creation of these required contracts.

3.6 Workstream 5: Venture Investing

Description of workstream:

This workstream describes the support Oxentia will provide in establishing an investment vehicle. For the purposes of this proposal we have assumed that the investment vehicle will be a separate company, and it is referred herein as the KU investment firm.

Workstream Deliverables:

3.6.1.Governance Framework (D5.1)

Oxentia will support the development of the investment fund, including putting in place the governance framework. This deliverable will include:

- **Creating a board charter**: this will be a formal document that outlines the roles, responsibilities, composition, and governance principles of the board of directors within the KU investment firm. The document will describe the board composition, including number of directors, expertise and qualifications and relevant experience required by the board members.
- Establishing the board roles and responsibilities: the responsibilities of the board is to represent the shareholders and oversee the firm's operations. Their main responsibilities are likely to include tasks, such as; setting the strategic direction of the firm, ensuring that the firm adheres to legal and regulatory requirements, ensuring the risk management process is fit for purpose, and setting executive compensation.
- Determining meeting and reporting frequency: frequency of board meetings, decision making process, required committees (audit, investment, risk etc.) their charters and reporting requirements.
- Describing the reporting structure and relationships in the firms leadership teams: the relationship between the CEO and the board, the relationships between committees, management and the board, and the importance for effective communication between all parties.

The governance framework will also include **creating the investment committee charter**, who's role will be to provide oversight, guidance, and strategic direction for the firm's investment activities.

To facilitate operations a **Delegation of Authority (DOA) Matrix** will be created. The DOA will clarify the decision-making hierarchy within the investment firm, ensuring that roles and responsibilities are well-defined, and appropriate checks and balances are in place. The DOA will be accompanied by a RASCI matrix to clarify the roles and responsibilities of individuals for completing tasks and management feedback.

3.6.2.Investment Process (D5.2)

Oxentia will develop the standard operating procedures around the investment process for the KU investment firm. This will include, creating the:

- **Investment procedure**: the steps and processes that need to be followed to identify, evaluate, execute, monitor, and exit investment opportunities. Including setting out the investment strategy and objectives; the SOPs for every stage of the investment from performing due diligence on individual investment opportunities, negotiating investments, through to exiting.
- **Template investment two pager**: to communicate with future partners we will develop a template investment firm two pager. This document will provide a concise overview of the

KU investment firm, summarising key investment activity by; sector, asset class, stage of investment, typical investment size, etc. It will also include key information about the team, including an overview of the team, portfolio of investments, and a description of the firms USPs and benefits of co-investing with the KU investment firm.

- **Template investment committee memo**: to provide a standardised and structured format for presenting investment opportunities, updates, or recommendations to the investment committee. The purpose of the template is to ensure that investment related information is communicated clearly to the board, and beyond facilitating investment decisions, it also supports the firm in documentation and record keeping and adhering to its compliance requirements.

3.6.3. Investment Team Organisation (D5.3)

Oxentia will support the **definition of the investment firm**, e.g. its size, structure and the different job roles it encompasses. When required we will also facilitate the creation of **job descriptions**.

3.6.4. Bilateral Co-Investment Partnerships (D5.4)

We will also facilitate a **pipeline of co-investment opportunities** for the KU investment firm. These co-investment opportunities are expected to be sourced either internally, through companies already located in the Techno Park, or; externally via the bilateral partnerships with international universities and research institutes.

Oxentia will engage the partner organisations to coordinate investment opportunities. This will involve presenting the KU Techno Park investment opportunity to Spinout teams and (where spinout teams are not fully formed) technology transfer managers supporting their incorporation.

Where potential investment targets decline the investment opportunity, we will gather feedback to understand the reasons behind their decision, so that their feedback can be used to improve future co-investment offers.

3.7 Workstream 6: Consulting and Lab services

Description of workstream:

The sixth workstream describes the support Oxentia will provide in establishing the consulting and lab services unit within KUEC. This unit will be responsible for seeking out and managing consulting opportunities for KU academics. The unit will also seek out and manage contracts where external organisations (usually the R&D departments of private companies) want to access KU laboratory facilities. Typically, these opportunities arise because universities have expensive equipment that companies would like to use occasionally, but do not have the funds or usage requirement to justify purchasing the equipment themselves. Equally these companies benefit from accessing the expertise that Universities have in managing, operating and maintaining equipment.

Workstream Deliverables:

3.7.1. Definition of the KUEC Consulting and Lab Services offering (D6.1)

Oxentia will **define the 'KUEC Consulting and Lab Services'** strategy and operations. The contents of this deliverable will be similar to TMI strategy and operations (D2.3) in workstream 2, and will include a review of all governance and operating procedures for the unit. Including:

- Defining the objectives and scope

- Establishing the governance structure
- Development of policies and procedures
- Development of workflows, protocols and template forms

3.7.2. Review applicable costings for Consulting and Lab Services (D6.2)

For this deliverable we will create a database of consulting and lab services available across KU. We will liaise with faculty heads to determine what laboratory services are already available, and the costing information for those services.

For consultancy services we will survey the academic staff to collect information on their level of consulting experience, interest in providing consulting services and costing information. We will also liaise with the KUEC team regarding costing information of consultancy and laboratory services already provided.

The deliverable will be a database of consulting expertise and laboratory services available at KU, and the costs of delivering these services.

3.7.3. Consulting and Lab Services team organisation (D6.3)

Oxentia will support the definition of the Consulting and Lab Services unit, e.g. defining its size, structure and the different job roles that the unit requires. When agreement has been reached on the organisational plan we will facilitate creation of the team, by creating **job descriptions** for the different roles.

3.7.4. Lab Services, policy and sales processes (D6.4)

Oxentia will work in collaboration with various university stakeholders to establish the **pricing policy for Lab services**. This will include defining the **procedures to sell and manage lab services**, for private companies seeking to access university equipment. The main steps we will take, are:

- Research and consultation with faculty heads and selected academics to developed a understanding of the needs and expectations of both the university and private sector stakeholders. This will involve analysing the university's capabilities, identifying available laboratory resources, and evaluating the specific requirements of potential private clients
- Develop a policy framework to govern access, usage guidelines, pricing structures, and intellectual property rights. The policy framework should strike a balance between fostering collaboration and protecting the university's interests.
- Establish sales processes, which involves developing marketing materials, creating service packages, and defining pricing models that align with industry standards while considering the unique value proposition of the university's laboratory services. Effective communication channels are also set up to facilitate inquiries, bookings, and ongoing customer support.
- Regular monitoring and feedback mechanisms are implemented to ensure continuous improvement and customer satisfaction, allowing the university units to adapt and refine their individual offerings.

3.7.5. Consulting services, policy and costings (6.5)

Oxentia will also provide the **pricing policy for consulting services**, and the **procedures to sell and manage consulting services**. This work will be done in parallel with the previous deliverable (6.2), and by following the same key steps.

3.8 Timeline

This project will take approximately 28 months to complete from the kick-off meeting. Our expectation is that the project will start on the 1st September 2023 and finish on the 31st December 2025. The Gantt chart (on the following page) shows the main project activities and deliverable start dates and due dates.

Deliverable	KUEC Project Activities & Timeline	kick-off /interim deliverable	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28
		Months	30 Sep 2023	31 Oct 2023	30 Nov 2023	31 Dec 2023	31 Jan 2024	29 Feb 2024	31 Mar 2024	30 Apr 2024	31 May 2024	30 Jun 2024	31 Jul 2024	31 Aug 2024	30 Sep 2024	31 Oct 2024	30 Nov 2024	31 Dec 2024	31 Jan 2025	28 Feb 2025	31 Mar 2025	30 Apr 2025	31 May 2025	30 Jun 2025	31 Jul 2025	31 Aug 2025	30 Sep 2025	31 Oct 2025	30 Nov 2025	31 Dec 2025
	Workstream #1 : Overall Project																													
D1.1	Detailed Project Plan	Project kick-off meeting	♦			◊																								
D1.2	KUEC Strategy					◊																								
D1.3	KUEC operating model							◊																						
D1.4	Project Management (in-person meetings)	face-to-face PM meetings	♦			♦			♦			♦			♦			♦			♦			♦			♦			♦
	Workstream #2 - TMI & Licensing																													
D2.1	Review Performance of TMI	TMI kick-off meeting & KPI dashboard	♦			◊			◊			◊			◊			◊			◊			◊			◊			◊
D2.2	IP Policy and revenue sharing review	workshop							♦		◊																			
D2.3	TMI strategy and operations	TMI kick-off meeting							♦						◊															
D2.4	IP portfolio review	TMI kick-off meeting							♦						◊															
	Workstream #3 - Incubation Services (KIC)																													
D3.1	KIC strategic review	kick-off meeting										♦						◊												
D3.2	KIC portfolio performance review	kick-off meeting										♦						◊												
	Workstream #4 - Techno Park																													
D4.1	Innovation ecosystem benchmarking study	stakeholder interviews										♦			♦			◊												
D4.2	Techno Park: vision, business plan, and objective setting	TMI kick-off meeting													♦			◊												
D4.3	Techno park tenant agreements	TMI & legal team kick-off meeting																♦			◊									
	Workstream #5 - Venture Investing																													
D5.1	Governance Framework	kick-off meeting																♦			◊									
D5.2	Investment Process	kick-off meeting																			♦			◊						
D5.3	Investment Team Organization	kick-off meeting																			♦			◊						
	Workstream #6 - Consulting & Lab Services	**Oct 31st**																												
D6.1	Definition of the KUEC Consulting and Lab Services offering	kick-off meeting																			♦			◊						
D6.2	Review applicable costings for Consulting and Lab Services	faculty interviews																♦			♦			♦			◊			
D6.3	Consulting and Lab Services team organisation	kick-off meeting																			♦						◊			
D6.4	Lab Services, policy and sales processes	kick-off meeting																									♦			◊
D6.5	Consulting services, policy and costings	kick-off meeting																									♦			◊

	expected period of work on deliverable
♦	in-person kick-off or interim deliverable
◊	deliverable due date

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4. Our team

Sample profiles of selected consultants who may be involved in the delivery of this proposed work are included below. Profiles of all Oxentia Consultants can be viewed at www.oxentia.com.

4.1 How we will manage the project

Bruno Reynolds will be our assigned ***Project Manager***, he will have overall responsibility for the execution of the project - for realising the project plan in terms of time, quality and budget and being the main point of contact for Khalifa University and Alexandra bush, ***Project Director*** who will peer review all activities and deliverables. Alex will also attend the kick-off meeting, interim meetings and final review meeting and be an additional point of contact.

Good project management, built around the following features, will help ensure that we deliver the project successfully:

- Setting clear objectives and expectations – at the start of our work together, Oxentia will organise a kick-off meeting to agree the work and methods of execution. The output from this meeting will be an updated version of our proposal which will function as a Project Initiation Document (PID) setting out the project's deliverables, milestones and activities which will be used by the PM for day-to-day management of our work.
- Open, regular communication – effective contact between the Khalifa University and Oxentia teams will be essential. The dedicated PD and PM will be available to Khalifa University at all times to discuss project progress and issues.
- Regular reporting – The PM will have fortnightly update meetings with Khalifa University to review project progress. Any risks, slippage or deviations from scope will be highlighted, and the appropriate mitigation strategy discussed with you.

4.2 Biographies of key consultants who will deliver the project

4.2.1. Dr Steve Cleverley, CEO

Steve is the Chief Executive Officer and Chairman of the Board at Oxentia Ltd. He is also managing director of Oxentia Europe SL and a director of the Oxentia Foundation. Steve joined Isis Enterprise, the innovation management consulting division of Isis Innovation in 2011 as a senior consultant and became head of the group in 2014. In 2017, he led the management buy-out of the division to form Oxentia Ltd and commenced his role as CEO. Under his leadership, Oxentia has continued its strong international growth, now having worked in over 70 countries and developed new training and consulting offerings across its Higher Education, Corporate and Government sectors.

Steve has over 28 years of experience in sales, marketing, and product development, developing market entry strategies and launching new products and services. A significant amount of Steve's work has been for government agencies and SMEs in the UK and abroad. He

has directed and managed several strategically important programmes including the creation of a new private university in Oman Muscat, development of university feasibility plans in Guernsey and Vietnam, international accelerator programmes in Malaysia, the Middle East and Latin America, and corporate challenge-based programmes for a multinational bank. Steve has also led and severed as a coach and trainer on the multiyear partnership with the Royal Academy of Engineering's Leaders in Innovation programme.

Steve holds a BA (Hons) in Biochemistry from Oxford, a PhD in Immunology, and an MBA from Henley Business School specialising in International Trade.

4.2.2. Dr Alexandra Bush, Director of HE Services

Alexandra has a background in knowledge exchange and commercialisation (KEC), strategy development and programme management and heads up Oxentia's engagement with Higher Education Institutes (HEIs) and Public Sector Research Organisations (PSREs). She has co-developed and led workshops for universities and government departments both in the UK and internationally to support new initiatives leading to more targeted commercialisation of intellectual property (IP). This has included IP policy reviews and reviews of other related policies linked to technology transfer (TT) and assessing organisational frameworks and structures to provide recommended best practice approaches to deliver KEC. Alexandra has worked with universities in the Middle East, Far East, Latin America, Europe and the UK delivering ATTP accredited and bespoke training to Higher Education Institutes and Public Sector Research Organisations. She has supported spinout companies in developing business plans and pitches to secure investment. She has also worked with corporates in understanding their technology scouting needs and identifying opportunities for acquisition.

Alexandra is a member of the Royal Society of Chemistry Applied Materials Chemistry Group, focusing on industrial uses and opportunities for materials which significantly enhance or determine the performance of a product (e.g. healthcare, ceramics, water and waste treatment). With a PhD in chemistry she has experience of working in industry, government funded organisations and universities across a range of sectors at senior/executive level.

4.2.3. Dr Hamish McAlpine, Principal Consultant

Hamish has over a decade of experience in knowledge exchange and commercialisation. He works with our HE, research organisation and government clients, delivering consultancy, strategy development and training on knowledge exchange and commercialisation (KEC) as well as innovation management.

As a Principal Consultant at Oxentia, Hamish leads on maximising effective delivery of projects for HE and Government clients, delivering training for KEC professionals and entrepreneurs, and supporting KEC and innovation strategy and delivery.

Before joining Oxentia in 2021, Hamish was the Head of Data & Evidence at Research England, part of UK Research & Innovation (UKRI). He was responsible for creating England's first Knowledge Exchange Framework, as well as managing £250m per annum of KE funding, and being involved in government policy development related to knowledge exchange and commercialisation.

Prior to that Hamish managed large, industrially-engaged research projects at the Universities of Bath and Bristol, with a particular focus on their pathways to impact and commercial opportunities arising from them.

He has particular expertise in:

- Knowledge Exchange & Commercialisation strategy and delivery
- Data and analysis related to KEC, including data collection, benchmarking and developing metrics.
- Compliance with funding terms and conditions
- Intellectual Property Strategy
- Training in KEC related activity
- For English Universities, advice on the operation of the Higher Education Innovation Fund (HEIF) and the Knowledge Exchange Framework, as well as compliance and data collection.

Hamish holds a PhD in Engineering information management and an MEng (first class Hons) in Manufacturing Engineering, both from the University of Bath. He is a PRINCE2 practitioner and Lean/Six Sigma black belt.

4.2.4. Dr Bruno Reynolds, Managing Consultant

Bruno has a background in Knowledge Exchange and Commercialisation (KEC), innovation management, and intellectual property management. He works with universities and companies at both the individual project level and more strategic organisational level. Bruno has supported university projects throughout their journey from the earliest stage of invention identification all the way through to commercialisation through licensing and spinout creation. From the University wide perspective Bruno has managed University KEC activities, including supporting the business case for incubators, patent portfolio optimisation, and managing translational funding programmes.

Bruno works with corporates on innovation management and IP portfolio optimisation. For SMEs this typically involves IP portfolio optimisation and internationalisation. For larger international companies this asset identification and IP due diligence.

Bruno's experience in innovation management is built on a solid foundation of academic research and business experience. In academia he has PhD and Postdoc in Life Sciences research from Cambridge and Oxford Universities, respectively. He has also studied and worked in the UK and abroad, completing an MBA and co-founding an innovation management company in Portugal.

4.2.5. Dr Sahand Zanjani pour, Consultant

Sahand joined Oxentia in January 2021. Since then, he has been working with universities, spinouts/start-ups, SMEs, multinational corporates, and government funding agencies. His expertise covers data analysis of HEI and corporate data, commercialisation process especially for software product and services, managing outreach campaigns and understanding market feedback, and opportunity scouting for multinational corporates.

Sahand's background is in computational biomechanics, and he co-leads the software and digital commercialisation training in Oxentia – he has recently developed a course structure for a masterclass aimed at early-stage entrepreneurs with software, digital, and artificial intelligence (AI) related products and services.

Sahand's previous experience as a PhD student and postdoc in multiple universities in computational biomechanics, including University of Oxford, and as an entrepreneur lead for a life science ICURe project supports him directly with what he offers to Oxentia's client.

Sahand holds Meng in mechanical engineering from University of Birmingham and PhD in biomedical physics from University of Exeter. He is also a certified sports massage therapist and competes in Olympic weightlifting competitions.

4.2.6.Lisa Lines, Programme Manager

Lisa is responsible for working collaboratively across the organisation, managing and delivering high quality global entrepreneurship and innovation projects.

Lisa's portfolio of work includes programmes such as Aspect (A SHAPE Platform for Entrepreneurship, Commercialisation and Transformation), Santander X Global Entrepreneurship Challenges and Royal Academy of Engineering LIF Global 2023, whilst also utilising her commercial background to assist with company operations and business development opportunities.

Lisa has previous experience managing custom Executive Education programmes for University of Oxford, Said Business School, working on strategic projects with partners in Japan and as client relationship manager for programmes in the Middle East.

Most recently, she has been working with the Oxfordshire Local Enterprise Partnership to provide developmental support programmes for SMEs within the region, facilitating significant capital investment and innovation grants supported by BEIS, UKRI, Innovate UK, and more.

Working across both public and private sectors, Lisa is skilled in aligning a diverse range of stakeholders' views to enable collaboration and promote business innovation, growth and skills development.

4.2.7.Dr Franziska Guenther, Consultant

Franziska works with companies around the world to support technology commercialisation through market and competitor analysis, technology scouting and IP landscaping. She has particular interest in medical, life sciences and pharmaceutical sectors, as well as in clean technologies that address global environmental challenges.

Before joining Oxentia, Franziska worked as a scientist at the University of Oxford, where she joined a highly collaborative drug discovery project alongside pharmaceutical industry partners. She participated in course modules in the 'Strategy and Innovation' elective at Said Business School to access key innovation and business concepts.

She has a broad biomedical background and holds a PhD in Neurophysiology.

4.2.8. Lizi Peretti, Senior Consultant

Lizi has a background in Knowledge Exchange and Commercialisation (KEC), innovation management, Science and Technology Parks and Entrepreneurship. She has over 12 years of experience in technology transfer, working closely with research organisations, government institutions and the corporate sector, often acting as an intermediary between these entities.

Lizi joined Oxentia in 2016 and she leads programmes and activities in Latin America. At Oxentia, Lizi has led Entrepreneurship programmes, designing and managing accelerators, internationalisation programmes, and capacity building for entrepreneurs as well as the delivery of comprehensive programmes to support universities, and government agencies, and to foster and develop regional innovation ecosystems. This includes accelerator and incubator programmes focused on specific deep tech fields, training programmes for mentors, policymakers as well as researchers, evaluators and investors.

Examples of relevant programmes may include Oxelerator Colombia, cohorts from 2018 to 2021; Secondment Programme for the Argentinean Agency I+D+I, SpinOut support programme for HubTec Chile, ITTP (Innovation and Tech Transfer Programme) Training and mentoring programme for the Peruvian innovation ecosystem, Innovation Policy Accelerator – Brazil. Within these projects, Lizi has managed and coordinated large teams and budgets, managing client and relationships between multiple stakeholders.

Lizi has also worked as an independent expert in Science and Technology Parks for the European Commission. Prior to this she spent four years as executive operations manager at Parque Tecnológico del Litoral Centro (PTLC), a leading science and technology park in Argentina. She also has a vast experience working at the technology transfer office of the Universidad Nacional del Litoral (Argentina), a pioneer in Tech Transfer in South America. During this time, she was part of the Evaluation Committee of the Forum for Innovation, an annual event bringing together universities, research agencies, banks, and investors.

Lizi has extensive experience in the evaluation and selection of projects for acceleration, mentoring entrepreneurs and monitoring the progress of spin out companies. In addition, she has significant

expertise in finance and marketing, gained during her time as operations manager at PTLC, and her work in the corporate sector.

4.3 Biographies of key associates who will deliver the project

4.3.1.Professor Rob Carroll

Rob is an accomplished investor and venture capitalist, as well as an educator. He started his career with a degree in Pharmacy at Boots before becoming an Investment Director at global investment house 3i and is currently a director of the Catapult Ventures Group, which has £130m under management across five institutional funds. His experience spans a range of sectors from healthcare and pharmaceuticals, medical devices, software, manufacturing and environmental, as well as all stages: from start-ups and pre-revenue IP developers to company flotation. Successful Group realisations to date include Atlantic Link (IRR 44%), Blackstar Amps (4.3x), Accutronics (9.0x), Oxford Cryosystems (5.2x), De-Pack (IRR 70%), R5 Pharmaceuticals (IRR 50%), Lumora (5.0x) and Whelan Refining (4.7x). Rob chairs the fund investment committees of the Regional Venture Capital Fund, Advantage Enterprise and Innovation Fund, Catapult Growth Fund and the GM&C Fund. In 2013 he became a Visiting Professor at Nottingham University Business School and was made a full Professor in 2016. He teaches students and delivers seminars for entrepreneurs on topics including Entrepreneurship, Venture Capital and Private Equity. Rob is also the Vice Chairman of Lord Young's Small Business Charter, which seeks to galvanise high growth SMEs via business schools, in order to drive economic growth.

4.3.2. Rick Norsworthy, Associate

A University of Nottingham Electronic Engineering graduate, Rick founded Riverfresh Limited almost 10 years ago after more than 25 years working in senior business, commercial and technical management roles for large multinational companies such as Plessey, Siemens and Affiniti. Operating directly and through established agreements with a select group of associate partners, Rick provides a range of services to high-growth scale-ups, start-ups, HEIs, Independent Research Organisations, corporate accelerator and open innovation teams both in the UK, Europe and Asia. He specialises in providing board advisory and accelerated commercialisation services and tends to work mainly with early and mid-career founders and entrepreneurs of rapidly growing software, data driven, advanced engineering high tech scale-ups through organisations such as Oxentia, the Royal Academy of Engineering, Oxford Innovation, Nottingham Business School, PA Consulting and Entrepreneurial Spark. He also works with scale-up or mid-cap businesses, University research centres, incubators, accelerators, funders who are looking to accelerate the adoption of innovative solutions in areas such as low carbon supply chain transformation, data and AI driven insights, robotics, IOT, drone-based solutions.

Rick is an Honorary Industrial Fellow University of Bristol, supporting both SetSquared (the leading global University Business Incubator partnership between Bath, Bristol, Exeter, Southampton and Surrey universities which specialises in growing technology start-ups

through its world class business support programmes) and QTEC (a world-leading pre-incubator which supports the development of next generation UK-based quantum and deep

technology start-ups, working with STEM researchers to provide them with the necessary training, skills and support to create their own technology start-up business). Rick is also a UKTI Sector Specialist and a panel member or board adviser with various organisations, such as the ICURe Options Roundabout

5. Previous experience

Oxentia is pleased to present the following case studies as relevant examples of our previous experience in below competencies.

We would be delighted to share more information and relevant experience upon request.

5.1 Governance and establishment setup

5.1.1.Oxentia established a New Private University in Oman (2012-2017)

Challenge: In September 2017, the Founding Committee launched Muscat University, a new academic institution that meets Gulf region's increasing need for an entrepreneurial workforce by placing the employability of its students at the heart of its ethos.

Oxentia has acted as the lead and sole consultant to the Founding Committee, providing a full range of higher education advice from the strategic to the practical, to achieve the establishment's desired local, regional and international impact.

Approach: Oxentia provided advice and practical support on every aspect of academic institution building, based on the concept of innovative and entrepreneurial higher education.

Oxentia has designed the university's academic programme based around three faculties: Business and Management, Transport and Logistics, and Engineering and Technology. The degree programme has a strong graduate focus and is led by a team of academics, hand-picked by Oxentia.

Furthermore, Oxentia advised on the critical components of the university's organisation, from staff recruitment policies to the architecture of its learning spaces. Oxentia has designed a Pathway Programme of Intensive English and Numeracy Lessons to ensure that the university's intake meets the exacting standards.

Impact: Overlaying every element of this project is a focus on both academic quality and entrepreneurship. Muscat University gained a strong foundation to become an institution of regional and ultimately international standing.

5.1.2. Feasibility Study for Guernsey International University, 2019 - 2021

Challenge: Guernsey International University is a planned initiative of the government entity of the States of Guernsey. Guernsey is a highly desirable destination that boasts and excellent standard of living. However, its geographic size and its population are relatively modest. Like any locale, care cost-benefit analyses must be made if planned initiatives are to delivery optimum value.

Approach: Oxentia was appointed as sole educational consultant to undertake a full feasibility study for the planned university initiative, reporting to the Committee for Economic Development within the States of Guernsey. Oxentia undertook detailed quantitative and qualitative analyses via regular interfaces with members of the university founding board, commercial and educational stakeholders, and would-be partner institutions. Ideal degree programmes for delivery in three cognate disciplines were identified and detailed benchmarking reports of competitor programmes were provided. Detailed operational models (including student and staff recruitment, research and knowledge exchange targets, and direct and indirect financial forecasts) were created. Subsequently, comprehensive risk and sensitivity analyses were performed. Awareness raising and professional development workshops were held with key staff at Officer level.

Impact: Oxentia's Gross Value Added (GVA) calculations were considered with careful gravity by the Committee for Economic Development. The effects of the ongoing COVID-19 pandemic and of recent elections were also taken into account. The Committee concluded that, due to the considerable capital investment that would be required, it would not immediately progress this project. The Committee of Education, Sport and Culture and the Committee for Economic Development have requested that Oxentia remain available as the situation may develop in the medium term. Key elements of Oxentia's work were assembled into a detailed report which is now available in the public domain via this web link: https://www.gov.gg/article/185270/

5.1.3. Oxentia support for the research IP commercialisation pipeline at Bournemouth University

Oxentia support for the research IP commercialisation pipeline at Bournemouth University. This follows a previous project delivered by Oxentia - IP & Commercialisation Strategy that identified an IP pipeline broader than patentable innovations.

Challenge: Over a 12-month period, 01 April 2019 – 31 March 2019, Oxentia built a strong partnership with Bournemouth University, building capacity through provision of technology transfer support, strategic recommendations and creation of commercialisation processes.

Approach: A mixture of onsite and remote support was provided to Bournemouth University to build and develop the research IP commercialisation pipeline. Oxentia supported to a total of 36 projects and held onsite and remote meetings with over 25 academics. Commercialisation potential and next steps were identified for each project resulting in the completion of over 78 IP portfolio related activities ranging from invention disclosure meetings, IP due diligence and market assessments to spin-out and licensing activities such as business plan support and identification and engagement with potential licensees. Oxentia's pitch support to three BU academics enabled them all to successfully obtain their start-up accelerator programme funding. In addition, to build BU's IP commercialisation capacity, new strategies and internal processes at BU were created.

Impact: A new process and framework for commercialisation was created at Bournemouth University. Projects were identified and evaluated for their commercial potential and clear route-to-market plans with milestones and timelines developed. All work was completed to contractual standards.

5.2 Knowledge exchange and commercialisation (KEC)

5.2.1.Realising the value of world-class research at Cranfield University (2012-19)

Challenge: When Cranfield University invested in developing their Research and Innovation Office, they were looking to partner with a leading innovation management consultancy that could develop a bespoke knowledge exchange and commercialisation (KEC) processes fit for their environment; manage the day-to-day commercialisation workload; introduce an entrepreneurial culture; develop relationships and increase investment from business; and, support the university's long term strategic development.

Approach: Oxentia provided long-term and regular onsite presence from a team of KEC consultants with a wide variety of technical expertise. End to end support for all commercial

activity was supported; from liaising with academics to identify potential commercial opportunities to negotiating licence agreements and supporting spinout companies. Good practice training was provided on a range of subject areas to academics and support staff to increase the level of entrepreneurial activities.

Impact: Cranfield University has one of the highest ratios of private sector to public sector research. Oxentia has established a KEC process and more entrepreneurial/industry focused culture, enabling the University to capitalise on their deep links into industry.

5.2.2. Bournemouth University (BU) research commercialisation support

Oxentia built a strong partnership with Bournemouth University, building capacity through provision of technology transfer support, strategic recommendations and creation of commercialisation processes including a spin-out framework and accompanying handbook.

Approach and outcomes: We provided technology transfer support through both onsite and remote meetings, building and developing BU's research IP commercialisation pipeline. Oxentia supported 30+ projects, at various commercialisation development stages, holding onsite and remote meetings with over 25 academics. Commercialisation potential and next steps were identified for each project resulting in the completion of over 78 IP portfolio related activities ranging from invention disclosure meetings, IP due diligence and market assessments to spin-out and licensing activities such as business plan support and identification and engagement with potential licensees. Oxentia's pitch support to three BU academics enabled them all to successfully obtain their start-up accelerator programme funding. In addition, to build BU's IP commercialisation capacity, new strategies and internal processes were created, including a spinout handbook, toolkit and 'sound bites' or information which BU could then use to create videos and other internal marketing outputs.

Impact: A new process and framework for commercialisation was created at Bournemouth University. Projects were identified and evaluated for their commercial potential, clear route-to-market plans, milestones and timelines developed and new potential partnerships explored. Oxentia's work enabled the BU Research commercialisation manager (RCM) to develop new research commercialisation processes and engage with relevant stakeholders in BU to progress opportunities in the research pipeline.

5.2.3. Knowledge Exchange and Commercialisation (KEC) Partnership. Sheffield Hallam University (2017-2019)

Challenge: Since 2017, Oxentia has been working with Sheffield Hallam University (SHU) in support of the university's research commercialisation activity.

Approach: As part of its work Oxentia has delivered a detailed assessment of IP assets, a training programme for research staff, a review of SHU's IP policy as well as specific project support.

Summary of type and scope of services provided:

- Intellectual Property (IP) portfolio review;
- Review and refresh of IP policy;
- Academic engagement programme – series of ten workshops;
- Development of processes to support commercialisation;

- On-going support for commercialisation of IP projects resulting in licence agreements, spinout companies, and collaborations with industry
- Scoping of business opportunities for CMSI – Analytical services. SHU project for Innovation Advisory Board (IAB) Application. Mentoring of the CMSI BD Manager.

Lessons learnt and relevance to this Contract:

- The ability to provide access to specialist networks and tools is a significant value add, particularly in small technology transfer offices, and was instrumental in securing deal flow in the commercialisation of technologies
- A regular on-site presence combined with remote support enables the development of effective relationships whilst maximising efficiencies
- It is beneficial to adapt the nature of support and mentoring in response to staffing changes within a client technology transfer office

Impact: Oxentia's understanding of commercialisation, the impact and interface on and with the academic community has enabled the University to reposition this activity to best support the new university strategy.

5.3 Investment and finance strategy

5.3.1. Developing an evidence-based funding model for a university science park accelerator programme (May – August 2022)

Client: A large UK-based university science park

Project description: Reviewing accelerator programme funding sources and developing an evidence-based funding model for a university science park accelerator to ensure it will become financially sustainable.

Challenge

As part of their expansion plans, a large UK-based university science park are seeking to build a formalised accelerator programme for physical sciences entrepreneurs and start-ups. By providing on-site training, support, and facilities to ventures at different stages of development, the accelerator will enable the park to build a world class innovation ecosystem for high-growth spin-outs from their affiliated university, as well as external innovators and ventures looking to benefit from access to the science park and university's expertise, facilities, and network.

In April 2021, the science park engaged Oxentia to carry out a benchmarking review of similar accelerator programmes and perform a gap analysis of their planned offerings. Oxentia's recommendations were incorporated into the science park's planned strategy for a three-staged accelerator: a pre-accelerator for early-stage innovators, a shared space accelerator, and a late-stage accelerator. Building on this work, the science park re-engaged Oxentia in May 2022 to carry out an evidence-based review of possible funding sources for their accelerator, with the aim of proposing a funding model that ensures the programme will become financially sustainable.

Approach

The key activities carried out to design the science park accelerator's funding model included:

Building a logic model: together with the science park team, Oxentia developed a logic model for the park's three-staged accelerator. This model detailed the theory of how proposed activities and interventions will produce the science park's desired outcomes and impact. The logic model represented an anchoring document for the development of the accelerator's funding model.

Evidence-based review of accelerator funding models: Oxentia carried out a benchmarking analysis of the offerings, funding models, and operational budgets of 22 similar accelerator and incubator programmes around the world. This review was used to provide evidence as to which funding sources may be most appropriate for the science park's accelerator, and how they could be implemented in practice to cover programme costs.

Funding options for the science park's accelerator: Oxentia used the evidence-based combined with experience in designing and developing accelerator programmes to provide the science park with a review of the advantages and trade-offs of implementing different funding sources for each of the accelerator's three stages. Following a workshop with the science park's team and stakeholders to gather input on the feasibility of different funding sources and validate assumptions, Oxentia provided a final series of recommendations for how the science park could combine funding sources and revenue streams across the three accelerator stages to deliver a financially sustainable support programme for physical sciences ventures at different stages in their development journey.

Impact

Oxentia's logic model for the university science park's accelerator and evidence-based review of funding sources and recommended funding model will be used by the science park team to secure buy-in from stakeholders across the University of Oxford. Once the accelerator plans approved, the logic model and funding recommendations will provide the science park's management with a blueprint to start building the accelerator.

6. Commercial proposal

6.1 Pricing

The quotation described below covers the delivery of the five work packages.

Table 1: Pricing breakdown

WS	Details	GBP
1	Overall Project D1.1 Detailed Project Plan D1.2 KUEC Strategy D1.3 KUEC operating model D1.4 Project Management (in-person meetings) Logistics	250,000
2	TMI & Licensing D2.1 Review Performance of TMI D2.2 IP Policy and revenue sharing review D2.3 TMI strategy and operations D2.4 IP portfolio review	150,550
3	Incubation Services (KIC) D3.1 KIC strategic review D3.2 KIC portfolio performance review	65,450
4	Techno Park D4.1 Innovation ecosystem benchmarking study D4.2 Techno Park: vision, business plan, and objective setting D4.3 Techno park tenant agreements	91,250
5	Venture Investing D5.1 Governance Framework D5.2 Investment Process D5.3 Investment Team Organization	130,500
6	Consulting & Lab Services D6.1 Definition of the KUEC Consulting and Lab Services offering D6.2 Review applicable costings for Consulting and Lab Services D6.3 Consulting and Lab Services team organisation D6.4 Lab Services, policy and sales processes D6.5 Consulting services, policy and costings	67,250
Total		£755,000.00

6.2 Taxes

This fee is exclusive of any applicable taxes, including government withholding tax.

6.3 Expenses

The fee is exclusive of all expenses (including all travel, accommodation and subsistence costs). These will be charged in addition to the fees above in accordance with the Oxentia Travel and Expense policy, a copy of which is available upon request.

6.4 Validity

This quotation is valid for 30 days from the date of this proposal.

6.5 Payment schedule

All payments must be received in full without deduction. Payment terms are strictly 30 days from date of invoice.

Table 2: Payment schedule

Payment	Date/description/milestone	%	Amount
1	On signing	10%	£75,500
2	1st quarterly meeting (December 2023)	10%	£75,500
3	2nd quarterly meeting (March 2024)	10%	£75,500
4	3rd quarterly meeting (June 2024)	10%	£75,500
5	4th quarterly meeting (September 2024)	10%	£75,500
6	5th quarterly meeting (December 2024)	10%	£75,500
7	6th quarterly meeting (March 2025)	10%	£75,500
8	7th quarterly meeting (June 2025)	10%	£75,500
9	8th quarterly meeting (September 2025)	10%	£75,500
10	9th quarterly meeting and project completion (December 2025)	10%	£75,500
Total			£755,000.00

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